Merlot AutoProcure AI — Non-IT User Manual

A Plain-English Visual Guide to Automated Stock Monitoring, WhatsApp Supplier Bargaining, and Store Protection

■ **What is this agent?** Think of Merlot AutoProcure AI as your **24/7 digital purchasing manager**. It constantly checks your store POS shelves, notices when popular indoor plants or fertilizers are running low, and drafts or sends polite WhatsApp messages to wholesale nursery suppliers to negotiate 15% to 25% lower prices.

1. Choose How You Want WhatsApp to Send Orders

You do not need to be a technical expert. The system offers two clear modes:

Option A: 1-Click WhatsApp **(Ready Today — Zero Setup Needed)**	**Option B: 24/7 Hands-Free WhatsApp** **(Automatic — Official Meta Cloud API)**
• **How it works:** When stock runs low, you click **'Auto-Restock via WhatsApp'**. It instantly opens WhatsApp Web or your phone app. • **Pre-written message:** The supplier's phone number, plant quantity, and discounted rate are already typed in for you. • **You are in control:** You review the message and press send with 1 click. • **Cost:** 100% Free. No API keys or credit cards needed.	• **How it works:** Connect your WhatsApp Business number once. The AI sends messages and bargains with suppliers completely on its own 24/7. • **Hands-free negotiation:** If a supplier replies *'We can do Rs 260'*, the AI reads it, counters back, and finalizes the Purchase Order. • **Cost:** 100% Free Tier (Meta includes 1,000 free supplier chats every month).

2. Non-IT Step-by-Step: Connecting Hands-Free WhatsApp

If you want the agent to negotiate completely hands-free, follow these simple 4 steps:

Step 1	**Open Meta for Developers** Go to developers.facebook.com and sign in with your Facebook account. Click **'Create App'**, choose **'Business'**, and give it a name like *'Merlot Procurement'*.
Step 2	**Add WhatsApp to Your App** Scroll down to **WhatsApp** and click **'Set up'**. Under the **'API Setup'** tab, you will see a field named **'Phone Number ID'** (e.g., 100609346426845). Copy this number.
Step 3	**Create a Secret Access Token** In Meta Business Suite > Settings > **System Users**, click **'Generate Token'** with permission whatsapp_business_messaging. Copy this private key string.
Step 4	**Paste into Merlot AutoProcure AI** In this dashboard, click **'■ WhatsApp & Auto-Restock Setup'**, paste your Phone Number ID and Key, and click **'Save & Apply Settings'**. You are done!

3. Store Safety Rules: Protecting Your Money & Profits

You never have to worry about the AI spending money carelessly. The agent follows strict guardrails:

■■ Auto-Approval Spending Cap (■25,000)	Any restock order that totals **under ■25,000** (or your custom amount) is approved automatically. Any order above this threshold is placed on **HOLD** and sends an alert to your phone for manager biometric or PIN sign-off.
■ Minimum Profit Margin (50%)	The AI will **never** accept a supplier quote that brings your store profit below your target margin (e.g. 50%). It will politely counter-offer until the price fits your target.
■■ Automatic Stock Scan Timer	You can choose how often the agent checks your POS: every 10 minutes, every hour, or only when you click 'Refresh Scan'.

4. Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ) for Store Owners

Common questions answered in plain, non-technical language:

Q1: Do I have to pay any monthly software subscription or cloud fee to use this?

No. The agent runs completely free of monthly charges. Meta includes 1,000 free supplier WhatsApp conversations every single month. Google AI Studio provides a free forever AI brain key. You do not need to pay any recurring SaaS fees.

Q2: What is the fastest way to test this right now without setting up Meta keys?

Use **1-Click WhatsApp**! Just open the dashboard and click the green button **'■ Auto-Restock via WhatsApp'**. It will scan low-stock plants and generate a live WhatsApp link. Clicking it opens WhatsApp directly on your phone or computer with the wholesale message pre-typed.

Q3: What happens if a supplier rejects the AI's opening price offer?

The AI uses professional nursery bargaining tactics (Ackerman concessions). If the supplier says *'Peat moss costs are up, we can only do ■280'*, the AI automatically replies politely: *'We understand logistics costs, but our corporate policy caps this at ■260. Since we pay instantly via UPI, can you meet us at ■260?'*

Q4: What is the 'Webhook' and why does WhatsApp ask for it?

Think of the Webhook as a **store mailbox**. When a wholesale supplier replies on WhatsApp, Meta sends their text message to this URL so your AI assistant can read it, negotiate the discount, and create your Purchase Order.

Q5: How does the agent know my inventory stock levels?

The agent is directly connected to your store's POS database (localdb.sqlite). Whenever a customer buys a plant at the counter, the stock number updates in real-time. When it hits the safety threshold (ROP), the agent alerts you.

Q6: What if my internet goes down? Will the store stop working?

No. The agent has a built-in offline failover engine. If cloud AI or internet connection is lost, it instantly switches to its offline math matrix and keeps monitoring without crashing.

Q7: Where are my wholesale vendor contacts and phone numbers stored?

In your store directory file vendors.csv. You can view, search, and edit your suppliers anytime directly from the top navigation menu under **'■ Wholesale Vendors CSV'**.

Q8: Can I speak to the agent in my regional language (Hindi, Marathi, Tamil, etc.)?

Yes! The agent includes Faster-Whisper Voice AI supporting all 22 Indian scheduled languages plus English. You can speak your restock instructions or search queries naturally.